Final Project Integrity and AI Usage Statement

Course: ITC 508 – Deep Learning and Natural Language Processing

Project Title: *Making Wage Rules Legible: Development, CPU-GPU Optimization, and Evaluation of a RAG Chatbot for Minimum-Wage Workers in Metro Manila*

Group Name: FineTunners

Project Integrity Declaration

We, the members of the FineTunners group, certify that this final project reflects the work we completed throughout the development, experimentation, and evaluation of our retrieval-augmented generation chatbot. The submitted notebooks, experiment records, evaluation files, source documents, and IEEE report represent the actual process followed by the group.

The project was developed using three official labor-related documents: the Labor Code of the Philippines, Wage Order No. NCR-27, and the 2024 Handbook on Workers' Statutory Monetary Benefits. These documents were processed, divided into searchable chunks, converted into embeddings, and stored in a Chroma vector database. The retrieved passages were then supplied to the Qwen3-1.7B language model to generate responses to worker-oriented questions.

The CPU and GPU experiments were conducted in Google Colab using the configurations described in the final report. The indexing times, retrieval times, generation times, generated answers, source passages, and other measurements included in the submission came from the actual execution of the notebook. We did not intentionally fabricate, alter, or misrepresent experimental data. When the chatbot produced an incorrect calculation, an inaccurate citation, or an unsupported statement, we recorded and discussed the issue instead of removing it from the evaluation. We considered this important because the weaknesses of the system are part of what the experiment was intended to reveal.

Each member participated in the project through an identifiable area of responsibility. These responsibilities are documented in the accompanying Member Responsibility Matrix. Although we discussed decisions and reviewed the completed work as a group, the matrix identifies the primary tasks and supporting evidence associated with each member.

We recognize that the completed chatbot is an educational prototype. It was designed to explore whether retrieval-augmented generation could make wage rules and statutory-benefit information easier to access and understand. Its responses should not be treated as professional legal advice or as an automatic determination of a worker's legal entitlement. Important employment concerns should still be verified through the official source documents or the appropriate government agency.

Generative AI Usage Disclosure

Generative AI tools, particularly OpenAI ChatGPT and Codex, were used as supporting tools during the development and documentation of this project. We used these tools to help explain programming errors, review possible code corrections, organize notebook sections, prepare code-cell explanations, improve the clarity of written paragraphs, suggest evaluation-question formats, and structure tables and supporting documents.

The use of generative AI was approached as a form of guided assistance rather than a replacement for the group's work. Suggested code changes were reviewed and executed by the group in Google Colab. The members observed the resulting outputs, investigated errors, compared CPU and GPU performance, examined retrieved passages, and manually assessed the final chatbot responses. Not every AI-generated suggestion was accepted, especially when it did not match the actual implementation or experimental results.

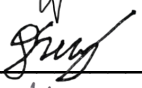
Generative AI was not used as the authoritative source of wage rules or statutory-benefit information. The project relied on the indexed government documents as its primary sources. The group remained responsible for verifying whether the chatbot's answers were supported by the retrieved passages and whether the reported calculations, citations, and conclusions were consistent with the recorded outputs.

AI-assisted writing was also reviewed and revised before being included in the final report. The purpose of this assistance was to improve organization and readability while preserving the observations and findings obtained from the group's actual work. We understand that the use of generative AI does not remove our responsibility for the accuracy, originality, and integrity of the submitted project.

Group Certification

By signing this statement, we confirm that:

1. The submitted files accurately represent the project completed by the group.
2. The reported experiments and evaluation results came from actual notebook executions.
3. The project's errors, limitations, incorrect responses, and partially correct responses were reported honestly.
4. Each member's contribution has been disclosed through the Member Responsibility Matrix.
5. The use of generative AI has been described openly and truthfully.
6. We reviewed and accepted responsibility for all material included in the final submission.

Group Member	Signature	Date
Sherina Anne P. Jaucian		November 11, 2026
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Justine Bradley S. Tulio		November 11, 2026